

First Tractor (0038.HK): High-HP momentum builds into 2Q26; reiterate Buy

First Tractor is scheduled to report 2Q26 results on August 25. Latest industry data point to a sustained recovery in China's agricultural tractor market, with medium-to-high HP production up 22% yoy and high-HP output up 41% yoy, supported by resilient exports, improving domestic demand, and a record-high high-HP mix. We expect First Tractor to benefit from the demand rebound and product mix upgrade, forecasting 25% yoy revenue growth and 40% yoy core EBIT growth in 2Q26, while net profit growth is likely to be more modest at 6% yoy due to a high base from one-off gains in 2Q25. We reiterate our Buy ratings on both A- and H-shares and raise our 12-m TPs to Rmb21.3 and HKD13.9, respectively.

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Industry trends in 2Q26:

- Industry production accelerated further in 2Q26 after the 1Q26 inflection. Medium-to-high HP tractor output has sustained 20%+ yoy growth since April, while high-HP tractors have maintained robust mid-double-digit yoy growth since May. As a result, 2Q26 medium-to-high HP tractor production increased 22% yoy, driven by a strong 41% yoy rebound in high-HP tractors, pushing second-quarter volumes to a record high.
- Supported by strong high-HP expansion, the high-HP mix within the medium-to-high HP segment reached a historic high of 37% in 2Q26, nearly double the historical second-quarter average of 20%. By geography:
 - Despite ongoing geopolitical conflicts, exports maintained strong momentum in 2Q26, with medium-to-high HP tractor export volumes rising 40% yoy and high-HP tractor exports surging 56% yoy. By region, double-digit yoy growth was recorded across all key markets except Africa, where medium-HP tractor exports faced a high base last year.
 - Implied domestic demand, measured as production minus exports, posted solid 16% yoy growth in 2Q26, led by a notable 38% yoy increase in the high-HP segment. A key driver was favorable crop pricing, with the average price of major crops up 5% YTD and 10% above last year's trough.

First Tractor 2Q26 preview

- **Strong topline and core EBIT growth projected in 2Q26:** We believe First Tractor is a key beneficiary of the industry demand rebound and product mix

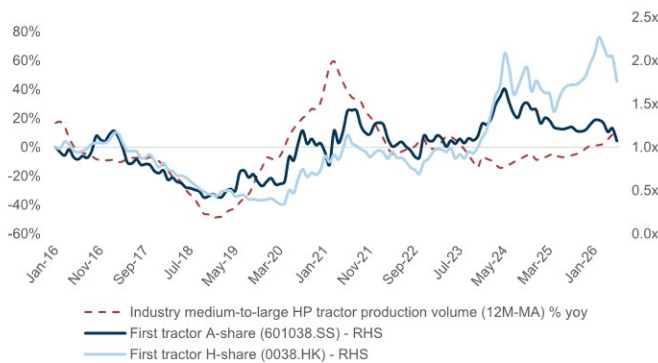
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improvement. We expect revenue to grow 25% yoy in 2Q26, with GPM expanding to 16.8% (+0.5ppt yoy / +0.3ppt qoq). As a result, we forecast core EBIT growth of 40% yoy. Given the large one-off gain recorded in 2Q25, we expect 2Q26 net profit to increase 6% yoy.

- **Valuation:** We maintain our 2026E–2028E full-year earnings forecasts, which remain 8%–18% above consensus. We roll forward our valuation base to mid-2027E, from end-2026E previously, leading to new 12-month target prices of Rmb21.3 / HKD13.9 for the A/H shares, up from Rmb19.5 / HKD13.0 previously.

Exhibit 1: First Tractor's share prices historically trade on tractor industry production volume

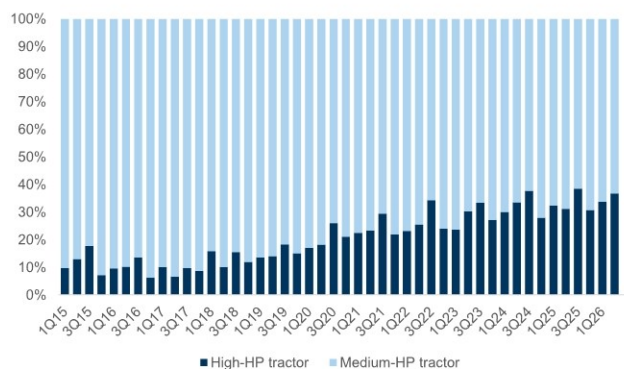
First Tractor's H/A share price performances (indexed) vs. monthly tractor industry production volume (12M-MA yoy chg%)



Source: Wind, NBS, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 3: The high-HP mix within the medium-to-high HP segment reached a historic high of 37% in 2Q26, almost doubling the historical 2Q average

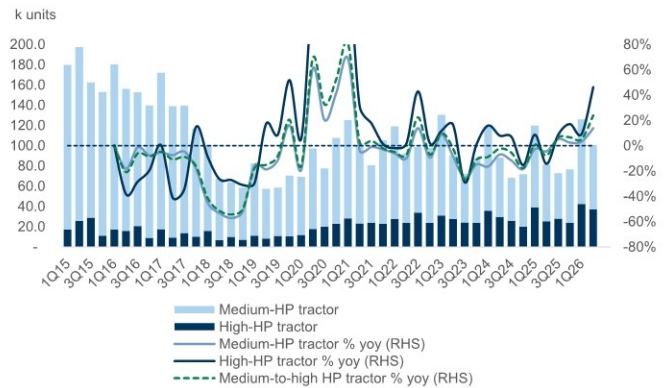
China quarter medium-to-high HP tractor production volume mix trends (1Q15-2Q26)



Source: NBS

Exhibit 2: China's medium-to-high HP tractors production volume saw strong growth of +22% yoy in 2Q26, with high-HP tractors recording robust rebound of +41% yoy

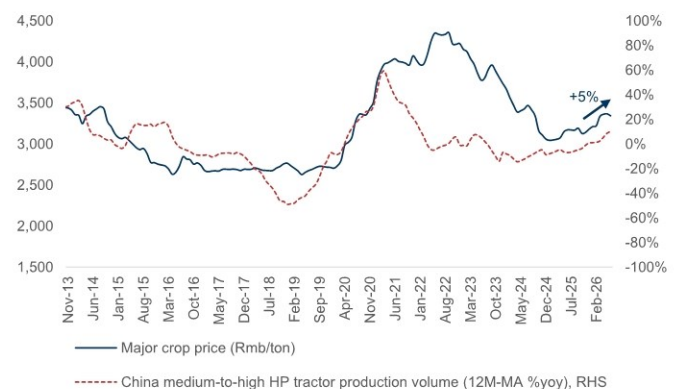
China quarter medium-to-high HP tractor production volume (k units) and % yoy (RHS)



Source: NBS

Exhibit 4: The average price of major crops saw solid growth of +5% YTD, up +10% vs. the low-end last year

China M/H-HP tractor monthly production volume 12M-MA chg% yoy (RHS) vs. average price of major crops



Source: NBS

Exhibit 5: Earnings revision summary

	Target Price (RMB/share)	Revenue			Net profit			EPS		
		2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2027E	2028E
First Tractor (601038.SS/0038.HK)		Rmb mn			Rmb mn			Rmb		
Gse (New)	RMB 21.30/HKD 13.90	12,591	14,857	17,134	947	1,163	1,471	0.84	1.04	1.31
Gse (Old)	RMB 19.50/HKD 13.00	12,591	14,857	17,134	947	1,163	1,471	0.84	1.04	1.31
% diff	9%/7%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%
Wind Consensus		11,662	12,614	14,222	904	1,057	1,203	0.80	0.94	1.07
% diff		8%	18%	20%	5%	10%	22%	5%	10%	22%

Source: Company data, Wind, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Price Target Risks and Methodology - First Tractor

Valuation: We derive our 12-m target price of HK\$13.9/share for First Tractor-H from an average of near- and long-term valuation. We apply a target P/E of 10.5x (in line with the long-term mid-cycle average) to 2026E/2027E average EPS to derive our near-term valuation, while applying a target P/E of 12x on 2030E EPS (referencing to the long-term mid-cycle average of its global peers), discounted back to mid-2027E using a CoE of 9.5% to arrive at our long-term valuation. Our 12-m target price of Rmb21.3/share for First Tractor-A incorporates a 67% A/H premium, consistent with the average A/H premium for First Tractor over the past 6 months.

Key downside risks: 1) weaker-than-expected crop prices; 2) unfavorable changes in gov't subsidy policy for agricultural equipment; 3) intensifying market competition; 4) execution risks relating product mix upgrade; 5) slower-than-expected localization of key components; 6) slower-than-expected progress in overseas market expansion.

Investment Thesis - First Tractor

First Tractor is China's largest producer of agricultural tractors by sales revenue in 2024. We view First Tractor as well positioned to capture the structural growth opportunities brought by China's tractor upsizing (towards high-HP tractors) and upgrading (towards intelligent tractors) trend in light of China's transition towards agricultural modernization to achieve food security. Exports, presenting c.3x the TAM opportunity in EMs (c.US\$10bn) vs. the domestic market (2024), could add another leg of growth over the long term as First Tractor builds its global competitiveness. We believe these structural shifts should drive a gradual convergence of First Tractor's margin and return profiles towards its global peers and warrant a re-rating for the stock, which we view as undervalued. We are Buy rated on both A-share and H-share.

0038.HK	12m Price Target: HK\$13.90	Price: HK\$8.62	Upside: 61.3%
601038.SS	12m Price Target: Rmb21.30	Price: Rmb13.79	Upside: 54.5%

Buy		GS Forecast			
Market cap: HK\$9.7bn / \$1.2bn Enterprise value: HK\$7.6bn / \$970.1mn 3m ADTV: HK\$33.6mn / \$4.3mn China China Battery, Machinery & Advanced Materials M&A Rank: 3 Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: Yes		12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
	Revenue (Rmb mn)	10,822.6	12,591.4	14,857.2	17,133.8
	EBITDA (Rmb mn)	815.3	997.4	1,285.6	1,646.4
	EPS (Rmb)	0.72	0.84	1.04	1.31
	P/E (X)	9.1	8.8	7.2	5.7
	P/B (X)	0.9	0.9	0.9	0.8
	Dividend yield (%)	4.1	4.2	5.1	6.5
	N debt/EBITDA (ex lease,X)	(1.8)	(2.4)	(2.8)	(3.0)
	CROCI (%)	11.6	13.1	15.5	19.0
	FCF yield (%)	9.1	15.6	20.2	22.6
		3/26	6/26E	9/26E	12/26E
	EPS (Rmb)	0.50	0.22	0.25	(0.13)

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 21 Jul 2026 close.

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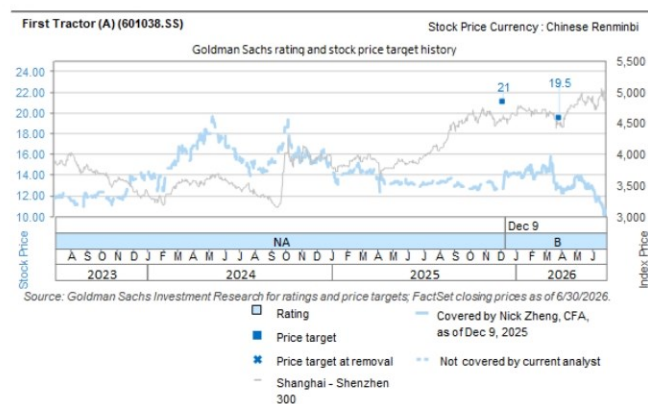
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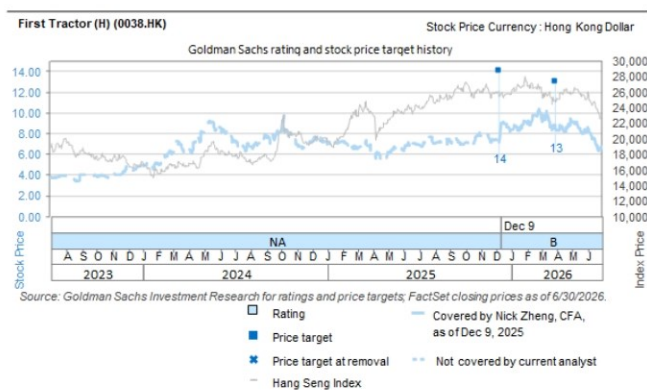
	Rating Distribution				Investment Banking Relationships		
	Buy	Hold	Sell		Buy	Hold	Sell
Global	50%	34%	16%		65%	59%	43%

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Target price history table(s)

First Tractor (H) (0038.HK)

Date of report	Target price (HK\$)	Closing price (HK\$)
30-Mar-26	13.00	8.41
09-Dec-25	14.00	7.20

First Tractor (A) (601038.SS)

Date of report	Target price (Rmb)	Closing price (Rmb)
30-Mar-26	19.50	12.75
09-Dec-25	21.00	12.69

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